

From these developments we would conclude that the imperative for distressed investing is to be as big as an elephant, quick as a bunny, and clever as a Roaring Kitty.⁵ In other words: it's complicated. To the young and impetuous distressed investors of tomorrow, I say, fear not! For the answers are here, in the wise prose of Graham and Dodd. First, the capital advice, disregarded by many an esteemed colleague over the years yet reliably valuable in my experience: "We ought as far as possible to know what we are talking about." (Chap. 4) Second, if all else fails, remember this: "As the Danish philosopher Soren Kierkegaard noted, life can only be understood backward—but it must be lived forward."⁶

⁵ Roaring Kitty is the Twitter name of Keith Patrick Gill, an American financial analyst and investor, whose posts on social media were cited as a driving factor in the GameStop short squeeze of January 2021.

⁶ Benjamin Graham, *The Intelligent Investor*.